

COSMETOLOGIST



SALARY

Newly qualified cosmetologist ★★★★★
Salon manager ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Growing demand for speciality beauty treatments • Opportunities in a wide range of specializations and settings, from health salons to home visits • Self-employment common

JOB DESCRIPTION

Cosmetologists specialize in making people look and feel good. They provide a range of facial and body treatments—such as manicures, pedicures, hair removal, eyebrow shaping, and specialized therapies—to improve the appearance and well-being of clients. A cosmetologist may also offer advice on recommended treatments, the use of cosmetics and skin products, and makeup application techniques.



CAREER PATHS

Cosmetologists start their careers by mastering the basics of a range of treatments, such as waxing, massage, facials, and skin care. Adding to your skills by taking courses in specialized techniques—such as piercings or advanced massage—will increase your career prospects and appeal to employers.

TRAINEE You can combine work experience in a salon or spa with on-the-job beauty cosmetology training by taking a paid trainee position.

COLLEGE GRADUATE You can become a cosmetologist by completing a vocational college training course, which combines lectures and classes with practical experience. Full-time or part-time courses are available.

COMPLEMENTARY THERAPIST

Performs a range of specialized health therapies—such as body massage, aromatherapy, reflexology, or hydrotherapy—that complement traditional forms of medical care.



COSMETOLOGIST As a cosmetologist, you will continue to learn new techniques and utilize new products throughout your career. You may specialize in a type of treatment, or move into salon management or cosmetics sales.